

SOARING ABOVE ADVERSITY: How I Navigate Life's Challenges and Walk with Purpose

I usually board a school bus to and from school, however, during my JSS3 session, it was announced that the school bus would no longer be available due to a sudden increase in fuel prices. Parents were advised to find alternative means of getting their children to school.

Although my parents suggested that I could use a public motorcycle, I had to trek a long distance before I could finally get one that would take me to school. Luckily, I had a bicycle that I could ride on the streets, but I was not experienced enough to ride on the main road because of the big trucks and their loud horns, which seemed very scary to me.

Thanks to my cousin, who taught me how to ride my bicycle on the road and not to be afraid of the loud horns, I began to gain confidence. He showed me a safe lane to ride my bicycle from home to school and back. On the first day I rode my bike with my cousin, it took me thirty minutes to get to school. By the time I arrived, I was very exhausted from riding such a long distance for the first time. After resting for a few minutes, it also took me another thirty minutes to get back home.

After two weeks of continuous practice, I noticed improvement. It then took me only twenty-two minutes to ride to school and the same time to return home. Eventually, I was able to ride my bicycle to school and back without my cousin accompanying me, and I was no longer afraid of trucks coming from behind or in front of me.

Now, I can ride my bicycle with confidence from home to school, instead of just riding within the streets as I used to before. In my school, I am the first and only female bicycle rider, and this has encouraged other male students who own bicycles to start riding from home to school and back.

Another experience I recall was when I failed my History exam in Grade 6. I was very sad and ashamed of myself, especially because my

Common Entrance Examination was approaching. At first, I felt like giving up, but I gathered the courage to overcome my failure and decided to do better before the examination.

I studied hard, not only focusing on History but on other subjects as well. With perseverance and diligence, I improved greatly and was able to pass my Common Entrance Examination and my other exams too. Soon, I became one of the best students in my class.

Through these experiences, I have learned to face my challenges with courage and determination. No matter the difficulty, I keep moving forward with purpose through difficult situations, knowing that I can overcome any obstacle and soar high above adversity.